



GDD 13

Puberty Quest

Your body's growing up, and that's normal

The puberty game for ages 9-12, built to the mechanic-embodiment standard, and the first Chapter 3 node, where the register turns matter-of-fact and the play goes private. Children learn what's changing and why, periods without shame, boys' changes too, and where to get true answers. Seven mechanics, 23 myths busted, zero "tap the right card". Scorecard: passed.

Your body's growing up, and that's normal.

Puberty Quest is the timely puberty node, the deeper, 9-12 sequel to Body Lab Juniors (g06). It explains what changes and why, normalises a wide range of timing, demystifies periods and busts the taboos around them, covers boys' changes honestly, and points kids to trusted sources for the questions they're too shy to ask. It opens Chapter 3, where, the personas tell us, the door closes and the internet becomes the teacher, so this is built private, solo, accurate and matter-of-fact. New v2 build to the standard.

FIELD	VALUE
Node / gameld	g13 · puberty-quest (confirm exact id against engine-host)
Chapter / ages	Chapter 3 · ages 9-12 · light canvas · private / solo
Thread / topics	A · Body & Growing Up · UNESCO 6.3, 6.1, 6.4, 6.5, 7.2
Prerequisite / builds on	Chapter 2 capstone · builds on g06 (Body Lab Juniors)
Gating	Core
Schema / status	v2 · scorecard PASS new build; first Chapter 3 node.

85

scenarios

7

mechanics

24

real-choice moves

23

myths busted

0%

binary taps

When the door closes.

From the Chapter 3 personas. At 9-12 embarrassment becomes the gatekeeper, this game answers what they can't bring themselves to ask a grown-up.

PERSONA	WHAT THEY NEED HERE	THE MECHANIC THAT SERVES IT
Diya, 11 (just got her period, mortified)	Private, accurate, shame-free period info.	strike-rewrite + reflect: it's normal; you're not 'impure'.
Aarav, 12 (gaming, "be a man")	Honest boys' info before the feed defines it.	branch + strike-rewrite: wet dreams normal; emotions okay.
Asha, 24 (peer educator)	A near-peer, trusted voice kids confide in.	match + reflect: trusted sources; calm facts.
Rekha (parent, joint family)	"Normal, without starting a fight" with elders.	branch: dignity within differing customs.
Lakshmi (period poverty)	Access, dignity, staying in school.	branch + reflect: ask for products; don't miss school.

Why this works (the evidence). Puberty starts across a wide band (girls ~8-13, boys ~9-14), so the key messages are "a wide range is normal" and "we'll prepare you before it happens". And in India ~23% of girls drop out after starting menstruation, with taboos ("impure", can't touch food) doing real harm, so busting them, privately and without shame, is high-stakes work.

Seven moves, calm facts.

The rework's heart: puberty arrives through seven actions, led by busting myths and deciding real moments, never a lecture. Mechanics rotate; the same one never runs twice in a row.

MECHANIC	THE CHILD DOES	EMBODIES	N
strike-rewrite	Erases a puberty or period myth, writes the fact.	Conceptual change; busting taboos.	23
reflect	Checks in privately on feelings and understanding (no wrong answer).	Normalisation; self-awareness.	23
branch (dilemma)	Decides a real moment (first period at school, asking for help).	Preparedness; dignity; agency.	20
match	Pairs change to cause, source to trust-level.	The facts; information literacy.	6
sort	Sorts normal-vs-not, truth-vs-myth, reliable-vs-risky.	Telling them apart.	5
build	Builds a first-period kit / self-care routine / fact card.	Preparedness, made concrete.	4
role-play (voice)	Rehearses asking a trusted adult; reassuring a friend.	Help-seeking; peer support.	4

24 of 85 moments are branch or role-play; binary "tap the right answer": **0%**. Heavy on strike-rewrite because puberty, especially periods, is buried under myths.

The two-test, passed.

Is it fun (for a 12-year-old)?

"Fun" here means relief and respect: a calm, private, near-peer space (Lensy as a slightly older guide, never childish) that finally answers the mortifying questions, no parent in the room, no judgement. The quest framing, "level up your understanding of your own body", and the satisfying click of a scary myth being busted, are what keep Aarav and Diya in, where a cutesy tone would make them close it instantly.

Is it teaching?

Yes, the core puberty curriculum: what changes and why, the wide range of normal, periods explained and de-stigmatised, boys' changes (including the ones no one warns them about), body care and moods, and how to find trusted answers, all accurate, inclusive and shame-free.

The belief it moves. From "something's wrong with me; a period makes me impure; boys must be tough and silent; I should hide all this; whatever I read online is true" → "this is normal and on my own clock, periods are clean and normal, boys have feelings too, there's no shame, and I get my answers from trusted sources."

Built, not bolted on.

85 researched scenarios across six categories, India-grounded (menstrual taboos, period poverty, "be a man") and inclusive (girls, boys, own timelines). Full library in the companion JSON.

CATEGORY	N	LEAD MECHANICS	COVERS
What puberty is	14	strike-rewrite, reflect, sort	What & why; hormones; wide range of normal; not gross; not alone.
Changes for girls	14	strike-rewrite, branch, build	Periods explained; products; cramps; breast changes; first-period kit.
Changes for boys	11	strike-rewrite, reflect, branch	Voice, wet dreams, erections, growth; emotions okay; not a race.
Body care & moods	13	branch, strike-rewrite, build	Sweat/odour, acne, sleep, growth hunger, mood swings, self-care.
Periods without shame	17	strike-rewrite, branch, role-play	Not impure; can cook/school/play; products & dignity; period poverty; allies.
Where to find out	16	branch, match, strike-rewrite	Trusted adults/health workers; internet isn't always right; ask, don't guess.

A strike-rewrite scenario (busting a harmful taboo), verbatim.

UN (erase): "A girl on her period is impure or dirty."
 RE (write): "A period is clean and natural; no one is 'impure' for menstruating."
 why: "It's a normal, healthy body process."
 relearn: "Menstruation is clean and natural; no one is 'impure'."

Full library: [SwipeEd — GDD 13 Puberty Quest — Scenario Library.json](#) (85 records, v2 schema).

What this game erases.

MYTH (UN ERASES)	TRUTH (RE WRITES)	BASIS
My body changing means something's wrong.	Puberty is the normal, healthy way your body grows up.	Puberty basics.
Everyone goes through puberty at the same time.	It starts ~8-14; everyone's on their own clock.	Timeline variation.
A period means something is wrong or I'm hurt.	A period is a normal, healthy monthly cycle.	Menstruation basics.
A girl on her period is impure or dirty.	A period is clean and natural; no one is 'impure'.	India menstrual taboos.
Girls on their period can't touch food / cook.	Menstruating people can cook and touch any food safely.	India taboos.
Girls must miss school during their period.	With a pad/cloth and care, you can go to school as normal.	Period & education.
Real boys don't get emotional during puberty.	Hormones bring mood changes for everyone; boys' feelings are normal.	Gender / emotional health.
A cracking voice / acne / wet dreams mean something's wrong.	All are normal, expected puberty changes.	Puberty basics.
Whatever I read online about my body is true.	A lot online is wrong; check trusted sources.	Information literacy.

23 UN→RE scenarios in total, the densest myth-busting set so far, reflecting how much misinformation surrounds puberty and periods.

The micro-loop.

1. **Hook.** Lensy (near-peer): "real talk, here's what's actually happening to your body".
2. **Play.** One of seven mechanics, led by myth-bust or decide, rotated.
3. **Fact lands.** A calm, accurate answer replaces a worry or a taboo.
4. **UN → RE moment.** On a myth, UN erases it and RE writes the truth ("impure" → "clean and normal").
5. **Apply.** Build a first-period kit, plan how to ask a trusted adult, reassure a friend.
6. **Sticker.** The Puberty Quest badge; GameDone records once.

Signature surfaces: the **myth-bust** beat (especially the period taboos), a private **ask-anything** feel, and preparedness **build** moments. Inclusive of girls, boys and all timelines; private parts and processes named accurately at a kid-appropriate level.

Private, accurate, shame-free.

- **Register (Chapter 3 shift).** Matter-of-fact and near-peer, never childish; a 12-year-old must not feel talked down to, or they close it instantly.
- **Private & solo by design.** No "show a parent" beat; discreet entry; no audio required, embarrassment is the gatekeeper, so the app is the trusted, judgement-free source.
- **Accurate & inclusive.** Proper names, a wide range of normal, girls AND boys, on their own timelines; brief and factual on sensitive specifics (periods, wet dreams, erections), never graphic.
- **Bust taboos, respect families.** Period taboos are named as myths plainly, while acknowledging customs differ, the child keeps dignity ("you're never impure") without being told to defy elders.
- **Equity & dignity.** Period poverty handled with care: products are a need, asking for help is okay, no one should miss school.
- **Route onward.** Lasting low mood routes to Mind Matters (g38); "be a man" pressure links to the healthy-masculinity thread; trusted-source habit links to Smart Screen Heroes (g12).

v2 schema, scorecard-gated.

- **gameld. puberty-quest** — node.game === GameDone key === registry id (confirm exact id in engine-host).
- **v2 mechanic-embodiment schema.** Each scenario carries type + typed payload (strike-rewrite.myth, branch.options, reflect.options, match.pairs, sort.items/bins/key, build.pieces, role-play.yourLine). Reuses the shared templates from g09.
- **Scorecard-gated.** Passed all eight checks (7 mechanics, max 27%, 0% binary, 24 autonomy, 23 UN→RE, 6 personas, 100% completeness). Re-run score_gdd.py on any edit.
- **Privacy flags.** Tag node as private/solo (no parent-glance, discreet), per Chapter 3 app-layer rules; the first node to exercise them.
- **Cross-links.** Builds on g06; feeds The Amazing Journey (g14, reproduction) and Mind Matters (g38).
- **Generated path.** Label/order/thread changes flow through the xlsx + gen-path, never hand-edited path.ts.

Ethics contracts (never traded for engagement): private/solo, never childish; accurate & inclusive (girls + boys + all timelines); bust taboos while respecting families; dignity in period poverty; no graphic content; route to support; made-for-India.

Why this works.

- **Prepare before, normalise the range.** Puberty begins across a wide band (girls ~8-13, boys ~9-14); best practice is preparing kids before changes (periods, wet dreams), using proper names, and stressing a wide "range of normal", inclusive of all genders.
- **India's period crisis is solvable with truth and access.** Around 23% of girls drop out after starting menstruation and only ~36% use sanitary pads; taboos ("impure", can't touch food, must miss school) are myths that harm dignity, health and schooling, so accurate, shame-free info plus access is the intervention.
- **Private, near-peer, judgement-free.** At 9-12 embarrassment closes the door and the internet becomes the teacher; the evidence-based response is a trusted, private, matter-of-fact source that answers what kids are too shy to ask, exactly this node's design.

Citations accompany each scenario in the library JSON. 15 games now v2; Chapter 3 begins here. Next in Chapter 3: The Amazing Journey (g14).